



# FROM YOU

YOUR SUGGESTIONS AND THINGS YOU WANTED TO KNOW!

## VIDEOS FOR EFY PROJECTS

At times I have some doubts while constructing an EFY project. Someone had mentioned on a WhatsApp group that EFY publishes short videos to demonstrate working of the projects published. How can I watch these videos?

**Sachin Kumar**

**EFY.** Glad you asked. We have been publishing these proof-of-concept (PoC) videos since September 2021 to demonstrate the final output of projects published in EFY. To view these videos, refer to <https://www.electronicsforu.com/category/electronics-projects/diy-projects-video-tutorials>

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## CONTRIBUTING DIY PROJECTS

Can I share my DIY projects to be published in EFY or do you accept them from select authors only? If you do accept, are there any guidelines?

**Savita Rao**

**EFY.** We welcome contributors for DIY projects, and even technical articles, with open arms. We even pay an honorarium if we publish the contribution on our website or the magazine. We have published the guidelines for our authors at: <https://www.electronicsforu.com/news/what-is-new-at-electronicsforu-updates/faq-authors-contributors-efy>

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## CALCULATORS NEEDED

I often need to search the web for calculators for different electronics-related design challenges. Can Electronics For You not provide a list of such calculators on its website?

**Sumant Sinha**

**EFY.** We have good news for you. We have not only listed them but actually got 20+ calculators developed and published on our website. Check them

out at: <https://www.electronicsforu.com/electronics-calculators>

❑ How can we calculate the life of a battery? We need to know this while designing a charger project.

**Amit Rai**

**EFY.** We have a simple solution. Please refer <https://www.electronicsforu.com/special/battery-life-calculator>. Using this online calculator, you can calculate the life of a battery based on the nominal battery capacity and the average current that a load is drawing from it.

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## AUTOMATIC EXHAUST FAN

This is regarding the DIY article 'An Exhaust Fan That Switches On Automatically On Detecting Smoke' published in January issue. Couldn't this project be done without a microcontroller? In my opinion, it looks like a little bit of luxury. It has become a new trend (or fashion) to convert all analogue circuits to programmed digital ones. Engineering or designing is supposed to make everything simpler, low-cost, and more practical. Why do you publish such circuits?

**Timpani**

**EFY.** The author designed his circuit around Attiny microcontroller. His aim was to get readers acquainted with it. But you might be right. If you can design it without the MCU, please do share your DIY with us—we would love to publish it.

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## SMART SOS DEVICE

This is regarding the DIY article 'Smart SOS Device That Raises Alarm And Sends Location' published in May issue. I want to construct the project but I am facing problem with the GSM module SIM 8001, which does not connect to any network. I have inserted the SIM of BSNL (ACTIVE 2G) but the AT command shows the SIM number

through serial monitor and 'No Network.' Can you please help?

**Chandra Sekhar Behera**

❑ Can I use a 4G SIM in place of GSM module SIM 8001? How can I make this project 4G supported?

**M.R. Sinha**

**EFY.** The SIM 8001 used in the author's circuit is a 2G spectrum based GSM module. So please keep this in mind and insert a SIM that can automatically switch and connect to a 2G network. Also, there needs to be a good 2G network coverage in your area. Since the antenna is connected to the SIM 8001 module, it should get proper signal strength for its working. To get this project working on 4G spectrum, you can replace SIM 8001 with any 4G GSM module, like SIM7600. In that case you will also have to modify the code as per the GSM module.

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## VARIABLE POWER SUPPLY

This is regarding the DIY article 'Variable Power Supply For Upto 3A Current' published in April issue (also available at <https://www.electronicsforu.com/electronics-projects/variable-power-supply-for-up-to-3a-current>). Are heat-sinks essential for TIP127, LM317, and LM7809?

**Anmol**

**EFY.** Yes, heat-sinks are essential. Regulator ICs LM317 and LM7809 and power transistor TIP127 are available in TO-220 packages. For such packages, aluminium heat-sinks having a large surface area rather than a greater fin height are preferred. Please note, if the heat-sink surface is anodised or painted, it increases heat radiation. So, do not forget to use heat-sinks for them, especially with transistor TIP127 to get maximum output, as most of the current passes through it.

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